

# Soonhong Cho

## CONTACT INFORMATION

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| Address | Bunche 4289, University of California, Los Angeles<br>Los Angeles, CA 90095 |
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| Website | <a href="https://soonhong-cho.github.io">soonhong-cho.github.io</a>         |

## EDUCATION

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| 2027 | Ph.D., Political Science, <b>UCLA</b><br>Committee: Jeffrey Lewis, Chad Hazlett (co-chairs), Chris Tausanovitch, Ian Lundberg (Sociology) |
| 2025 | M.S., Statistics and Data Science, <b>UCLA</b>                                                                                            |
| 2018 | M.A., Political Science, <b>Seoul National University</b>                                                                                 |
| 2016 | B.A., Economics, Political Science (Minor: Philosophy), <b>Seoul National University</b>                                                  |

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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Causal Inference, Political Methodology, American Politics, Public Opinion

## PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

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1. **Soonhong Cho**, Doeun Kim, and Chad Hazlett. 2026. [Inference at the Data's Edge: Gaussian Processes for Estimation and Inference in the Face of Extrapolation Uncertainty](#). *Political Analysis*.

## UNDER REVIEW

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5. [Let Time Tell: Identification and Gaussian Process Estimation for Interrupted Time Series](#). [**Job Market Paper**]
4. [Non-existent Outcomes in Research on Inequality: A Causal Approach](#). (with Ian Lundberg) [**Minor revision**, *Sociological Methods & Research*]
3. Beyond Measurement-of-Mediation: Aligning Theory, Estimands, and Designs for More Credible Mediation-based Claims in Communication Research. (with Je Hoon Chae and Hyunjin (Jin) Song) [**2nd R&R**, *Human Communication Research*]
2. When Help Seems Optional: Institutional Projection Bias and Climate Refugee Disadvantage. (with Jieun Park and Margaret E. Peters)
1. Penalizing the Perpetual Foreigner: Partisanship, Gender, and Attitudes toward Asian Americans. (with Jieun Park and Jessica Hyeonjeong Lee)

## WORKING PAPERS/WORK IN PROGRESS

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3. Covariate Imbalance and Non-Overlap in Interrupted Survey Designs: A Gaussian Process Approach. (with Chad Hazlett)
2. Estimating Time-Varying Treatment Effects under Misspecification. (with Ian Lundberg)
1. A GP Synthetic Control Method. (with Chad Hazlett and Wenlu Xu)

## STATISTICAL SOFTWARE

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|                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
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| <a href="#">gpss</a>      | R package on CRAN. Gaussian Processes for Social Science: extrapolation-aware estimation and inference for interrupted time series, regression discontinuity, and general regression settings, with hyperparameters selected automatically. With Doeun Kim and Chad Hazlett. |
| <a href="#">pstratreg</a> | R package. Principal stratification for non-existent outcomes: estimates effects on outcome existence and effects among units whose outcomes exist under either treatment, using standard regression models. With Ian Lundberg.                                              |

## GRANTS, AWARDS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

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| 2023–2025  | <b>Conference Travel Grants:</b> UCLA Graduate Division (2023, 2024); CCPR (2025); Institute for Humane Studies (2025)                     |
| 2024       | <b>Travel Scholarship for ACIC</b> , Society for Causal Inference                                                                          |
| 2023–2024  | <b>Initiative to Study Hate Research Grant</b> (\$15,000), UCLA                                                                            |
| 2023–2024  | <b>Dissertation Year Fellowship</b> , UCLA                                                                                                 |
| 2022, 2023 | <b>Political Psychology Fellowship</b> , UCLA                                                                                              |
| 2018–2023  | <a href="#">Kwanjeong Educational Foundation</a> Scholarship (\$122,500)<br>A competitive scholarship awarded for doctoral research abroad |
| 2018–2020  | <b>Graduate Dean’s Scholar Award</b> , UCLA Graduate Division                                                                              |
| 2018–2020  | <b>Irma Polaski Fellowship</b> , UCLA Graduate Division                                                                                    |
| 2018–2023  | <b>Funding for doctoral studies: Fellowship and TA position</b> , UCLA                                                                     |
| 2017       | <b>Next-generation Researcher Fellowship</b> , Seoul National University                                                                   |
| 2016       | <b>Best Research Paper</b> , Social Science Research Grant, Seoul National University                                                      |

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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| 2025      | <b>Instructor</b> , UCLA<br>Data Analysis Workshop, PhD level (Fall 2025)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 2019–2025 | <b>Teaching Assistant/Fellow</b> , UCLA<br>Causality, PhD level (Spring 2025, Statistics & Data Science)<br>Quantitative Data Analysis, PhD level (Winter 2025, Sociology)<br>Causal Inference for Social Science, PhD level (Spring 2022) <a href="#">Lecture Notes</a><br>Politics & Strategy: Game Theory for Political Science (7 quarters, 2020–2023)<br>Introduction to American Politics (3 quarters, 2019–2023)<br>The American Presidency (Winter 2022) |
| 2016–2018 | <b>Teaching Assistant</b> , Seoul National University<br>Quantitative Political Analysis (Grad); Research Methods in Political Science;<br>Understanding and Analyzing Korean Politics; Studies in Chinese Politics                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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| 2024–2026 | <b>Graduate Student Researcher</b> , UCLA<br>Gaussian process methods for causal inference (with Chad Hazlett)                                       |
| 2023–2024 | <b>Graduate Student Researcher</b> , Cornell University<br>Principal stratification methods for non-existent outcomes (with Ian Lundberg)            |
| 2020–2021 | <b>Graduate Research Assistant</b> , UCLA<br>Construction and analysis of actual-ballot datasets, Los Angeles County, 1986–2010                      |
| 2016–2018 | <b>Graduate Research Assistant</b> , Seoul National University<br>Projects on statistical software, legislative behavior, and governance experiments |

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025 | American Causal Inference Conference, Detroit, MI                      |
| 2025 | Population Association of America Annual Meeting, Washington, DC       |
| 2024 | Society for Political Methodology Annual Meeting, Riverside, CA        |
| 2024 | American Causal Inference Conference, Seattle, WA                      |
| 2023 | American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA |
| 2017 | Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL      |

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

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**Reviewer** for Political Science Research and Methods

## OTHER ACTIVITIES

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|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024 - Present | Affiliated with <a href="#">California Center for Population Research</a>                                           |
| 2023 - Present | Affiliated with <a href="#">Practical Causal Inference Lab</a>                                                      |
| 2022 - 2025    | <b>Graduate Student R Maven</b> , UCLA<br>- Provide statistics/programming support for graduate students as a tutor |
| 2021 - Present | Affiliated with <a href="#">Inequality Data Science Lab</a>                                                         |
| 2017           | <b>Vice-President of Graduate Students Council</b> , Political Science Major, Seoul National University             |
| 2011-2013      | <b>Staff Sergeant</b> , Republic of Korea Air Force (2 years)                                                       |

## SKILLS

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R (advanced), Python (intermediate), C++, Stata, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, git/GitHub, Qualtrics